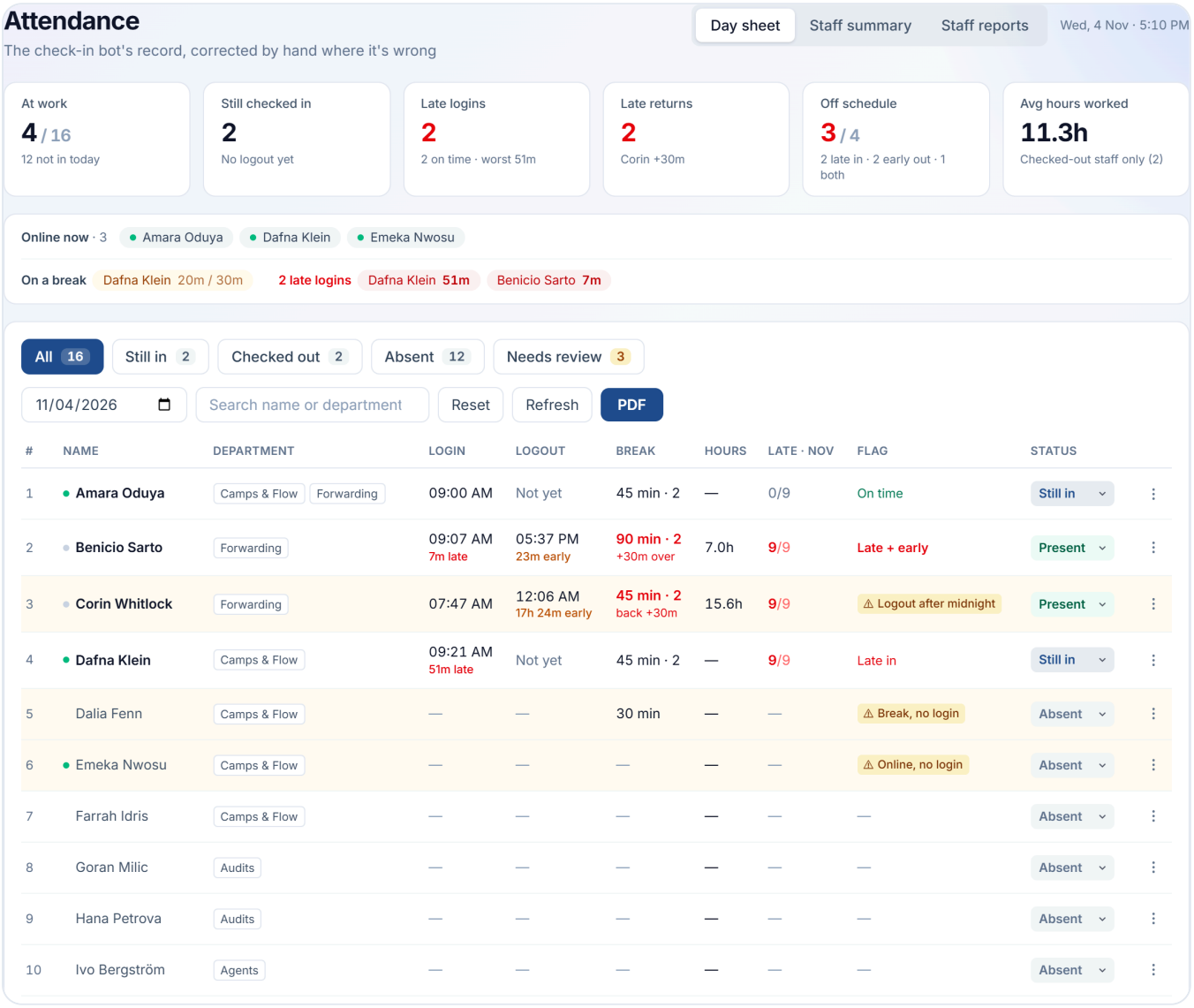
PLATFORM CRM · DESIGN

Attendance Design Principles

The rules behind the Attendance day sheet, written down so the page stays one coherent thing as it changes. They are taken from the design mock and applied in the build.



Derived from the attendance mock (Attendance.pdf) and the page built to it

November 2026

About this document

The designer's mock of the Attendance page was studied row by row and column by column. Every decision it repeats is written here as a rule: what it says, why it holds, and how the page applies it.

It is the companion to **Dashboard Design Principles**. The foundations there (Inter, the navy accent, flat white panels, sentence-case words, units beside numbers) apply here unchanged and are not repeated. This document covers what is particular to attendance: a table people read many times a day and correct by hand.

The screenshots use the local sample data. That data has nobody at work “today”, so the screenshot tool serves 10 Sep 2026 as today **inside the headless browser only**, with a few rows altered to show each state: still in, a logout after midnight, a break with no login, and someone online with no login. Nothing was written to the database. Section 8 lists where the build departs from the mock.

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1 What the page is for

The check-in bot records who logs in, takes breaks and logs out. It is usually right and sometimes wrong. The Day sheet answers three questions, in this order: **who is at work, who isn't, and which records can't be trusted yet?** It is also where a wrong record gets fixed.

1. **Header.** The page, its three views (Day sheet, Staff summary, Staff reports) and the org's clock.
2. **Six figures.** At work, still checked in, late logins, late returns, off schedule, average hours.
3. **Right now.** Who is online, who is on a break, who logged in late, named.
4. **Filter tabs.** All · Still in · Checked out · Absent · Needs review, each with its count.
5. **The table.** One row per person for the whole roster: the day as recorded, marked against their schedule.
6. **Correct a day.** The status pill changes the status in place; the ⋮ button opens the day for correction.

2 Ten principles

2.1 Read first, edit on purpose

Rows read as plain text: clock times, minutes, hours. Editing is one deliberate step away, in a small popover from the ⋮ button. The status pill is the only control in the row.

Why: the sheet is read dozens of times a day and corrected a few times a week. A grid of time inputs made every glance look like a form, and made a stray click into a stray edit. **Applied:** ⋮ opens a compact popover beside the row with login, logout, break and status, a live preview of hours and flag, the bot's breaks, and “Put back bot's record”. It never covers the sheet.

DO
“05:40 AM” as text; ⋮ to correct

DON'T
A time input in every cell of every row

2.2 Flag what needs a second look

When the bot and the clock times disagree, the row is tinted amber and the Flag column says what is wrong, in words: “Online, no login”, “Break, no login”, “Logout, no login”, “Logout after midnight”.

Why: these are the records most likely to be wrong, and the ones that throw off every count above the table. **Applied:** the “Needs review” tab gathers them, and its count is amber when it isn't zero. A review flag takes the Flag column's place ahead of the punctuality verdict, and the correction popover repeats it at the top.

2.3 Absence is the quiet default

Somebody who hasn't logged in reads grey: a regular-weight name, dashes, a grey “Absent” pill. Somebody who worked reads dark: a bold name and real times.

Why: early in the day most of the roster is absent. If absence were red, the page would be mostly red and nothing would stand out. **Applied:** the eye finds the people who are in by weight alone, and red stays free for what needs chasing.

2.4 Red is counted against someone; amber is to check

Red means a fault that counts against a person: a late login, a break over the allowance, a late return from break, late logins this month. Amber means something to look at that isn't a fault: an early logout, a review flag, someone on a break right now.

Applied: “7m late” under a login is red, and “23m early” under a logout is amber. In the Flag column, “Late in” is red, “Early out” amber and “Late + early” bold red. Green appears only for on time and, once anyone has logged in, a zero that is genuinely good news.

2.5 Live means today

Online dots, online chips and the on-break list describe right now, so they only appear when today is on screen.

Why: a green “online” dot on last Tuesday's row would be a lie. **Applied:** on a past day the panel says “Live status shows for today only”, and the name dot is grey for anyone who worked.

2.6 One list behind every figure

The six cards, the status panel, the tab counts and the table rows all come from one list of days, built in one function (`buildDayViews`).

Why: a card that says “3 late” above a table showing two late rows destroys trust in both. **Applied:** the late-login chips are the late rows, worst first. “Needs review 3” is exactly the amber rows.

2.7 Say it in words when nothing happened

An empty state is a short sentence, not a blank: “Not yet”, “· nobody right now”, “✓ No late logins · 18 on time”, “Everyone back from break on time”, “none yet, nobody has logged in”.

Applied: a logout cell for someone still in says “Not yet”, not a dash. A dash is kept for “nothing to show”, such as an absent person's hours.

2.8 Leave is never a fault

A person on leave (on the Leaves sheet, or with the status set to Leave) is never counted late, early, absent or in need of review.

Applied: their row reads “Leave” in violet, their times are not judged, and they are left out of “not in today” and counted separately (“· 1 on leave”).

2.9 Every figure with its denominator

A count is shown against what it is out of: “18 / 42” at work, “1 / 18” off schedule, “0/3” late logins this month, “Checked-out staff only (1)”.

Why: “1 off schedule” means nothing until you know whether 3 or 30 were judged. The denominator is lighter and smaller, so the eye still lands on the count.

2.10 A month in a cell

The Late · Nov column is the one figure in the row that isn't about the day on screen: late logins so far this month, out of the logins recorded.

Why: one late morning is rarely the point; the sixth one is. Reading that off a day sheet would otherwise mean opening thirty of them. **Applied:** “0/3” in grey, red once any are late, with the minutes lost and the worst one in the tooltip.

3 Colour and status

The Dashboard's tokens apply. These are the meanings particular to attendance:

COLOUR	ON THIS PAGE IT MEANS
Navy	Selected (active tab, filter, primary button) and “Still in” (navy text on a navy tint).
Online green dot	Checked in right now, today only.
Green text	On time; a good zero (no late logins, no late returns) once anyone has logged in; the “Present” pill.
Red	Counted against a person: late login, break over the allowance, late return, late logins this month, late + early.
Amber	To check: early logout, review flags and the amber row tint, the “Needs review” count, on a break now.
Violet	Leave: an agreed day off, never a fault.
Grey	Absent, holiday, dashes, a worked-but-offline dot. The page's resting state.

3.1 The status pill

The stored statuses keep their vocabulary and are written in sentence case. Each is a tinted pill with a chevron. It is a real select, so changing it saves the status for that day. Where nothing is stored, the pill shows what the clock times imply (a login and no logout reads “Still in”), and its tooltip says so.

STATUS	PILL	MEANING
Still in	Still in	Logged in, no logout yet.
Present	Present	A day worked.
Half day	Half day	A partial day.
Leave	Leave	An agreed day off.
Holiday / Absent	Absent	No day worked. Quiet by design (principle 2.3).

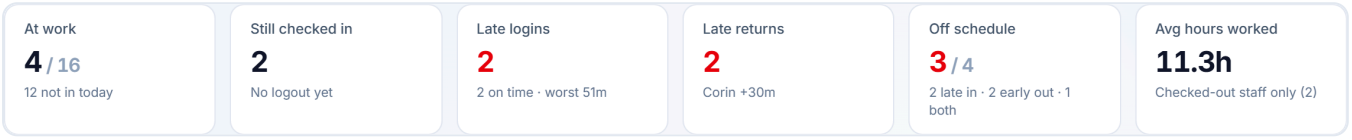
4 Components

4.1 Header



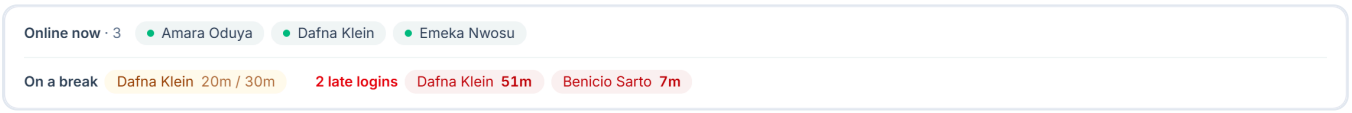
- Title and a one-line purpose on the left. The three views sit top right as a grey well with a raised white active tab, next to the org's clock (“Wed, 4 Nov · 4:12 PM”), which ticks every 15 seconds.

4.2 Six figures



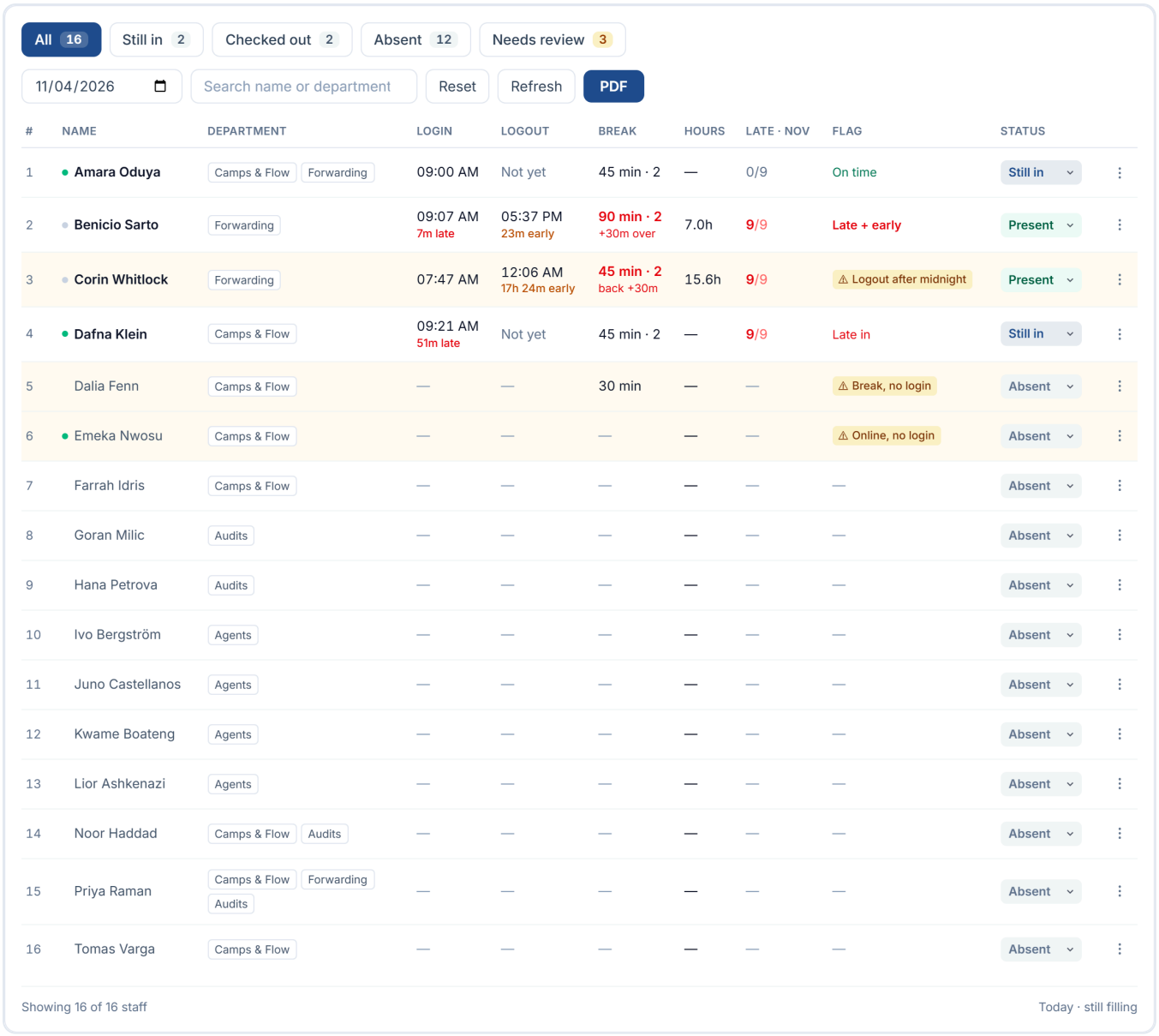
- Label, figure (with its denominator in lighter grey), then one line that explains it. Six across on a wide screen, three on a tablet, two on a phone.
- Late logins and Late returns name their worst case in the explaining line (“worst 51m”, “Corin +30m”). Late returns are added up per person, so two late breaks read “Corin +30m”, not “Corin +15m · Corin +15m”.

4.3 Right now



- First line: “Online now · N” and a chip per person (grey chip, green dot). Below a hairline: “On a break” chips (amber, red once past the grace) and the late-login chips (red, name plus minutes, worst first). When nobody is late, the line says “✓ No late logins”.

4.4 Filter tabs, toolbar and table



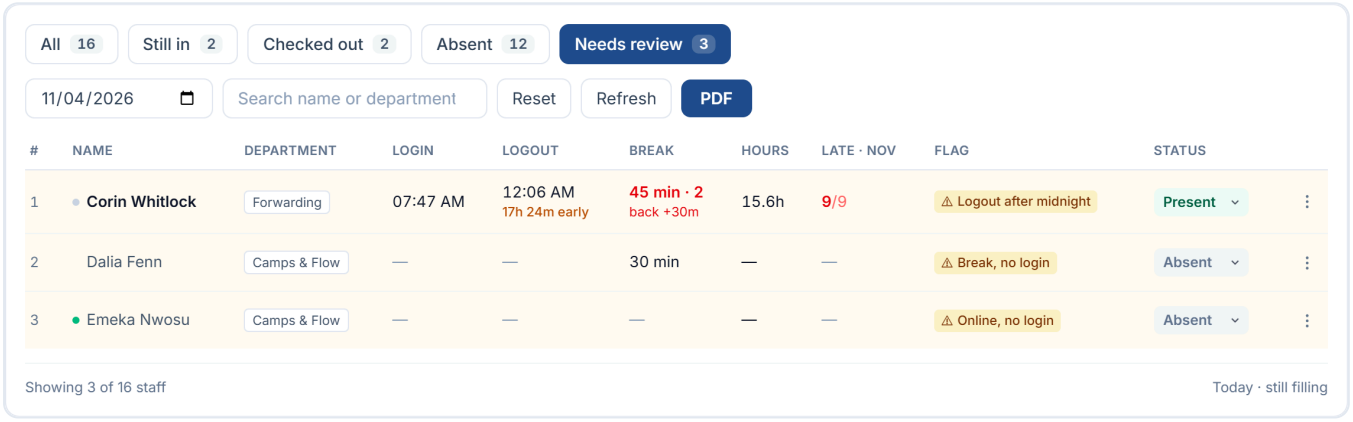
Rows 3, 5 and 6 need review: amber tint and an amber flag. Rows 1 and 4 are still in, and row 2 has checked out.

COLUMN	READS
#	Row number, grey.
Name	Dot (green online, grey worked, none absent) · name, bold if they worked · performer badge.
Department	Hairline chips, wrapping in place.
Login / Logout	“05:40 AM”; “Not yet” while still in; “7m late” in red or “23m early” in amber beneath it.
Break	“30 min · 1” (minutes · breaks). Red with “+30m over” or “back +30m” when it ran over. Click to see each break.

Hours	Net of breaks, one decimal.
Late · Nov	Late logins this month out of logins: “0/3”, red when any were late.
Flag	Review flag (amber chip) first, otherwise On time / Late in / Early out / Late + early.
Status · ⋮	The status pill; ⋮ opens the day for correction.

- **Tabs** are outlined buttons with a count chip. The active tab is solid navy; the “Needs review” count is amber when it isn't zero.
- **Toolbar:** day picker, search (name or department), Reset, Refresh, and PDF as the one primary button.
- **Footer:** “Showing 16 of 16 staff” on the left; “Today · still filling” or “Thu, Sep 10 · past day” on the right.

4.5 Needs review

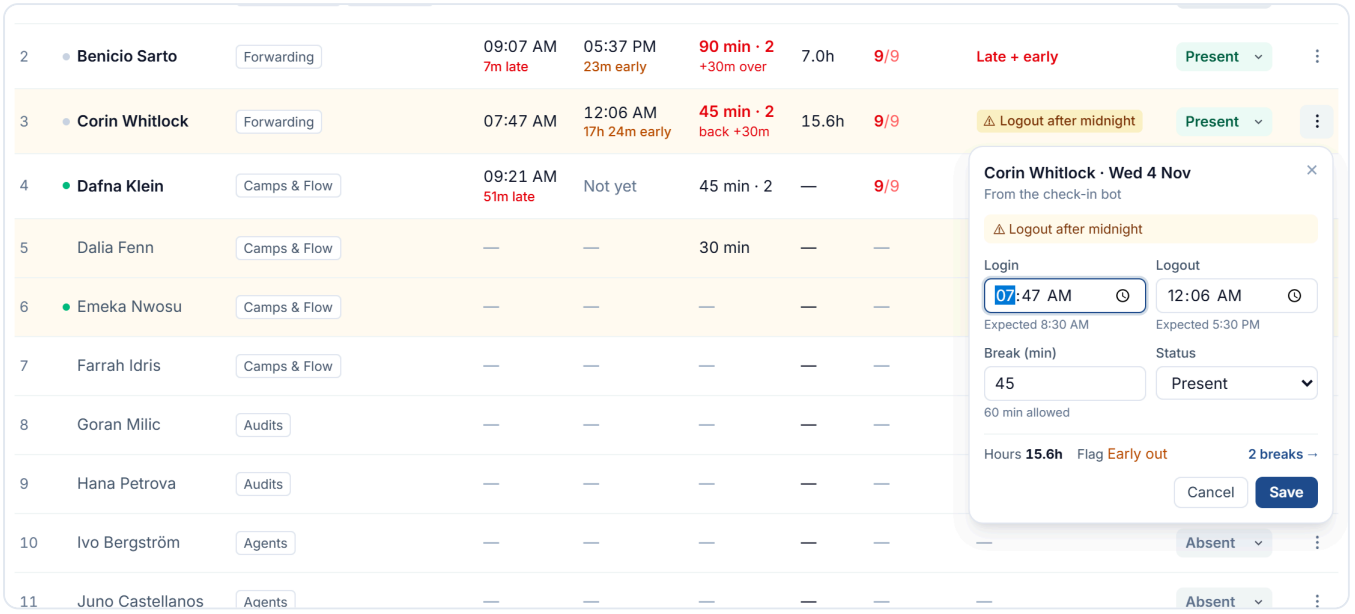


The tab narrows the sheet to the rows that disagree with themselves. In order of priority:

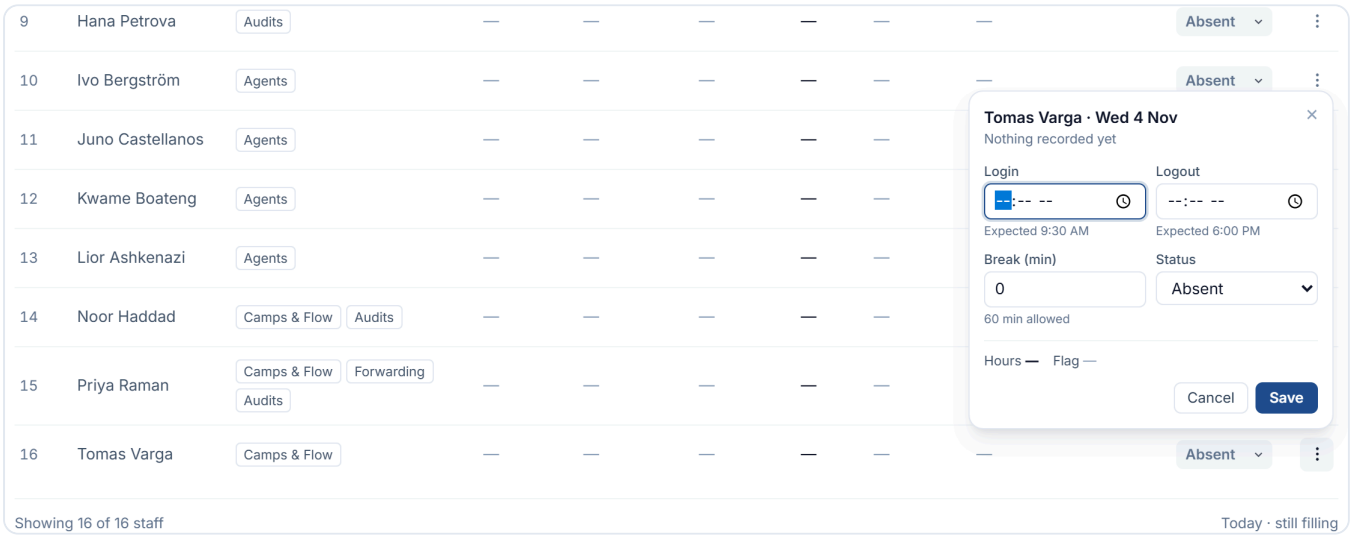
- **Online, no login:** the bot sees them checked in, but no login is recorded for the day.
- **Break, no login:** a break was recorded before any login.
- **Logout, no login.**
- **Logout after midnight:** the logout is earlier on the clock than the login. Either the shift ran past midnight or a time was mistyped.

4.6 Correcting a day

⋮ opens a small popover hanging from the button. It isn't a full-screen window: the row being corrected and the table around it stay in view.



From a row with room below, it slides down from the button, right edges aligned.



From the last row, near the bottom of the window, it flips and slides up.

- **Placement:** under the button, or above it when the space below is too short. It is kept 8px inside the window and follows the button while the page scrolls.
- **Motion:** a 150ms fade and a 6px slide in the direction it opens, switched off under `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- **Size:** 19rem × ~15rem. Name, day and where the record came from; any review flag; then login · logout and break · status in two columns, each with its expected time or allowance beneath.
- **Live preview:** hours and the flag update as you type; “2 breaks →” opens the bot's breaks.
- **Actions:** Save is the one navy button and Enter in a field saves. Cancel, Escape, a click outside or the ⋮ again all close it without saving. “Put back bot's record” undoes a correction (the bot's own data is never written to); “Clear entry” removes one keyed in by hand.

5 Numbers and words

WHAT	FORMAT	EXAMPLE
Clock time	Two-digit hour, 12-hour clock	05:40 AM · 12:06 AM
Off schedule	Gap, then “late” or “early”	7m late · 6h 54m early
Break	Minutes · number of breaks	30 min · 1
Hours	One decimal, “h”	15.8h
Count with base	Count / base, base lighter	18 / 42 · 0/3
Header clock	Weekday, day month · time	Wed, 4 Nov · 4:12 PM
Past day	Weekday, month day	Thu, Sep 10 · past day
Nothing to show	Em dash	—

5.1 Words

- Sentence case: “Day sheet”, “Still checked in”, “Needs review”, “Put back the bot's record”.
- Flags name the problem, not a code: “Online, no login”, never “ERR_NO_LOGIN”.
- The month column names its month: “Late · Nov”.

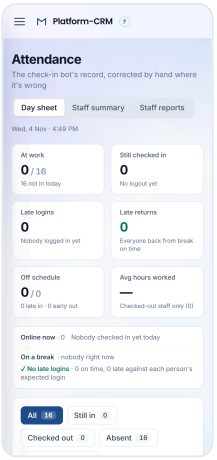
6 States

STATE	TREATMENT
Today, filling in	Online dots and chips, on-break chips, “Not yet” in logout cells, “Today · still filling” in the footer.
Nobody in yet	Zeros stay neutral, not green; the panel says “none yet, nobody has logged in” and the Late returns card “No breaks yet”.
Past day	No live state: the panel says “Live status shows for today only” and worked rows get a grey dot.
Loading / error	“Loading…” or the error in red, inside the table card; the cards above stay.
Empty filter	“Nobody matches — clear the search or pick another tab.”
Refreshing	The Refresh button reads “Refreshing…” and is disabled until the day is re-read.
On leave	A violet “Leave” pill; never judged, counted or flagged (principle 2.8).

7 Responsive and accessible

7.1 Down to a phone

- The header stacks: title, then the view tabs, then the clock.
- The cards go from six across to three, then two.
- The table keeps every column and scrolls sideways inside its own card. The page itself never scrolls sideways; at 390px the page width equals the screen width.



390px wide, the real empty “today”: neutral zeros and plain sentences.

7.2 Accessibility

- Colour is never the only signal: flags are words with a ⚠, late and early marks say “late” and “early”, and counts carry their labels.
- Every status pill is a labelled select (“Status for Amara Oduya”). Every ⋮ is a button labelled “Correct Amara Oduya's day”.
- Tabs use `role="tab"` with `aria-selected`. The date and search fields carry labels.
- Text is slate-500 or darker on white; slate-400 is kept for dashes and placeholders.

8 Departures from the mock

MOCK	BUILD	WHY
Status pill “Checked out”	The stored status, in sentence case (“Present”); the “Checked out” *tab* counts anyone with a logout	Statuses are stored values that staff, the Staff Summary and the exports already use. Renaming “present” on one screen would split the vocabulary.
⋮ with no behaviour shown	⋮ opens a compact correction popover beside the row (section 4.6)	The old sheet edited every cell inline. That ability had to live somewhere, and principle 2.1 puts it one step away.
Only “✓ No late logins” drawn	Late-login chips, named worst first, when anyone is late; on-break chips	The old page's late-login panel, folded into the status panel rather than lost.
“Logout after midnight” beside “6h 54m early”	Kept: the flag and the early mark both show	The early mark compares clock times and doesn't know about overnight shifts. The flag is what tells a person to check, and the mock shows the same pairing.
Late logins shown only at zero (green)	Red when any; neutral before anyone logs in	Principle 2.4, and a zero is only good news once there was something to judge.
Online chips on any day	Today only	Principle 2.5: “online” is a fact about right now.

> **To keep this document true:** when the Day sheet changes, re-run `tools/screenshots.mjs` and the shared `principles/tools/build-pdf.mjs` (see `README.md`), and update the matching principle in the same change.